

ROYAL COURT: STRUCTURED AUTHORITY

ROYAL COURT: STRUCTURED AUTHORITY IS AN NPC SUPPLEMENT FOR 5E THAT PRESENTS THE ROYAL COURT AS A functioning power structure rather than a loose collection of nobles. Instead of focusing on named rulers or setting-specific lore, this book provides a complete hierarchy of court roles—from pages and servants to sovereign authority—each defined by clear mechanical purpose and social standing.

The intent of this product is structural clarity and encounter utility without unnecessary CR inflation. Combat strength and political authority are intentionally separated: the highest-ranking figures are not always the deadliest, and the most dangerous warriors may hold limited social power. Each entry is designed to support a distinct court function—ceremonial control, treasury authority, arcane protection, intelligence gathering, logistical command, elite enforcement, succession politics, and sovereign rule.

Magical infrastructure is treated as essential in high-fantasy settings. The Crown Archanist exists to protect against scrying, enchantment, teleportation, and hostile spellcasting, ensuring the court remains a credible center of power in a world where magic is common. Meanwhile, the King's Guard represent lethal enforcement without political autonomy, reinforcing the distinction between authority and force.

Cultural lore, alignment assumptions, and dynastic history are intentionally minimal. Whether this court governs a sprawling empire, a struggling frontier kingdom, or a decadent city-state is left to the GM. These stat blocks are tools. How and why the court maintains order—or fails to—is yours to decide.

SOCIAL RANK

SOcial RANK REPRESENTS FORMAL AUTHORITY WITHIN THE ROYAL COURT. IT MEASURES INSTITUTIONAL POWER—NOT personal charisma, combat ability, or reputation. Rank only applies in structured court environments where titles, protocol, and royal authority are recognized.

By default, all creatures—including player characters—have Social Rank 0 unless explicitly granted a title or position. Rank 0 creatures hold no formal authority within the court hierarchy. They may be dismissed, commanded, escorted, or excluded by those of higher rank in accordance with protocol. All creatures entering the court—including player characters—are expected to follow its rules and protocol. These expectations are reinforced by subtle magical influence that encourages obedience to the court's authority.

At the DM's discretion, Social Rank may be granted temporarily (as part of an official commission, diplomatic mission, or royal favor) or permanently (through titles, knighthood, or noble appointment). Rank represents political access and leverage—but also responsibility and vulnerability. Those who rise within the hierarchy become subject to court expectations, factional pressure, scrutiny, and manipulation.

Social Rank does not remove player agency. It reflects how the court responds to authority, not mind control. High rank grants influence—but it also places characters directly inside the machinery of power.

ROYAL COURT ROSTER

Name	Social Rank	Challenge Rating	Description
Royal Page	1	0	Young attendant who observes more than others realize.
Palace Servant	1	0	Invisible infrastructure with access to private spaces.
Court Scribe	1	1/8	Official recorder and guardian of written authority.
Court Musician	1	1/8	Emotional tone-setter within formal proceedings.
Palace Guard	1	1/4	Ceremonial security maintaining visible order.
Court Jester	1	1/4	Licensed fool who wields social immunity through wit.
Herald	2	1/4	Formal voice of proclamation and royal presence.
Court Envoy	2	1/2	Diplomatic agent empowered to represent the crown.
King's Guard	2	5	Elite oathbound protector with lethal battlefield capability.
Master of Coin	3	1	Treasury authority controlling wealth and resource flow.
Crown Archivist	3	2	Arcane defender maintaining wards and anti-spying protections.
High Steward	3	2	Logistical authority overseeing palace operations.
Master of Whispers	3	2	Intelligence controller shaping information and secrecy.
Captain of the Guard	3	3	Military commander directing palace security.
Royal Advisor	4	2	Senior strategist influencing policy and succession.
Heir Apparent	4	2	Designated successor with growing authority.
Royal Consort	4	2	Influential partner shaping court dynamics.
Aged Monarch	5	1	Frail sovereign whose authority outlasts physical strength.
Monarch	5	3	Active ruler commanding both loyalty and enforcement.



COURT JESTER

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 18 (4d8)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)

Skills Acrobatics +4, Insight +3, Performance +5, Perception +3

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common plus one other

Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Social Rank 1.

Licensed Fool. The jester cannot be arrested or silenced within formal court proceedings without a direct order from a creature of Social Rank 4 or higher.

ACTIONS

Vicious Mockery (Cantrip). The jester targets one creature within 60 feet that can hear it. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or take 5 (1d4 + 3) psychic damage and have disadvantage on the next attack roll it makes before the end of its next turn.

- The jester speaks uncomfortable truths disguised as jokes.
- Nobles tolerate insults from the jester that would be punishable if spoken by anyone else.



COURT ENVOY

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 14 (fine coat, concealed chain shirt)

Hit Points 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)

Skills Insight +3, Perception +3, Persuasion +5, Deception +5

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Social Rank 2.

Diplomatic Immunity. While acting under official commission, the envoy cannot be lawfully attacked or detained by creatures of Social Rank 3 or lower without political consequence. Creatures of Social Rank 1 hesitate to strike the envoy unless directly ordered.

ACTIONS

Measured Words. The envoy attempts to cool escalating tensions. One creature within 30 feet that can hear the envoy must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or be unable to take hostile actions until the start of its next turn.

Rapier. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.
Hit: 5 (1d8 + 1) piercing damage.

REACTIONS

Veiled Threat. When a creature fails a Charisma check against the envoy, the envoy can impose disadvantage on that creature's next Charisma check before the end of its next turn.

- Envoys represent the crown abroad and carry political authority even outside the palace.
- Violence against an envoy can escalate quickly into diplomatic crisis or war.



KING'S GUARD

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 20 (plate, shield)

Hit Points 95 (10d8 + 50)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	12 (+1)	20 (+5)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Str +7, Con +8, Wis +5

Skills Athletics +7, Perception +5

Senses passive Perception 15

Languages Common

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Social Rank 2.

Oathbound Protector. While within 10 feet of a creature of Social Rank 4 or higher, the guard has advantage on saving throws against charm and fear effects.

Shield Wall. While within 5 feet of another guard, both guards gain +2 AC.

Unyielding Discipline. The guard cannot be frightened while it can see a creature of Social Rank 4+.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The guard makes two attacks with its longsword.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing damage.

Heavy Crossbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 100/400 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d10 + 1) piercing damage.

REACTIONS

Intercept Strike. When a creature within 5 feet of the guard is hit by an attack, the guard can become the target of that attack instead.

- King's Guards are elite defenders whose primary duty is protecting the royal family.
- They form disciplined defensive lines and willingly absorb attacks meant for their charges.



ROYAL ADVISOR

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 11

Hit Points 44 (8d8 + 8)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (–1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	15 (+2)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Wis +4, Cha +5

Skills Insight +4, Investigation +5, Persuasion +5, History +5

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Social Rank 4.

ACTIONS

Turn the Room (Recharge 5–6). The advisor targets up to three creatures within 30 feet that can hear them. Each target must succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw or be unable to take hostile actions until the start of the advisor's next turn.

Concealed Dagger. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 1) piercing damage.

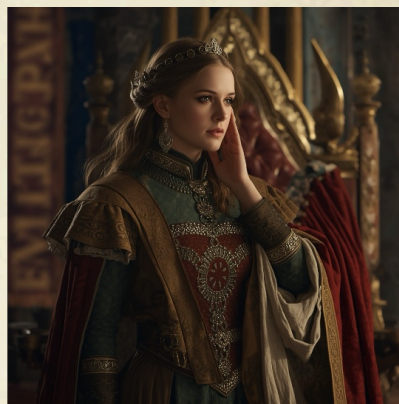
BONUS ACTIONS

Quiet Counsel. The advisor grants one creature within 30 feet advantage on its next saving throw or ability check made before the start of the advisor's next turn.

REACTIONS

Political Leverage. When a creature within 30 feet makes an attack against a creature of Social Rank 5+, the advisor can impose disadvantage on that attack.

- Royal Advisors rarely draw weapons; they control the room through authority and diplomacy.
- Their presence protects the monarch by manipulating social pressure rather than force.



AGED MONARCH

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 27 (6d8)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (–1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Wis +5, Cha +6

Skills Insight +5, Persuasion +6, History +4

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Social Rank 5.

Sovereign Authority. Creatures of Social Rank 1 or 2 within 30 feet must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw to willingly take hostile action against the monarch in formal court.

Lasting Presence. The monarch has advantage on saving throws against being charmed.

Fragile Body. The monarch has disadvantage on Strength and Dexterity saving throws.

ACTIONS

Last Decree (Recharge 5–6). The monarch issues a binding command to one allied creature within 60 feet. That creature may immediately use its reaction to move up to its speed and make one weapon attack.

Ceremonial Blade. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +1 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 – 1) slashing damage.

- The Aged Monarch's power lies in authority, reputation, and the loyalty of those around them.
- Even weakened by age, their command can still move armies and courts alike.



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